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THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

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A.P.S. Chapter No. 388

The PHILATEX

T.P.S. Chapter 3, Life Chapter 3

MEETING CALENDAR

MARCH			APRIL		
7	Juniors Board of Governors Meeting Program: 'Show & Tell' "Dub's Books" by Richard Spies	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	4	Juniors Board of Governors Meeting Program: 'Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
14	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	11	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
21	NO MEETING - GOOD FRIDAY	7:30 pm	18	Juniors Program: "Pictorial Cancellations" by Charles Shelby	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
28	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	25	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm
May 2 – BOG & program, May 9 – Auction					

EDITOR'S

CORNER

A friendly hello from your new editors, Dora & Lea.

We want to say thanks again to Bob & Pat Gray for 18 years of excellent service to our club. You are going to be a tough act to follow!

Readers, please be patient and even a little forgiving with us as we figure out what we are doing. If we make any mistakes, please let us know so that we can fix them. As we get better, the Philatex will get better, too.

Suggestions from our readers are most welcome. If you have articles to submit, ideas for things you would like to see in the newsletter, if there is someone special you would like to honor, or you have interesting stories about past members, if you have peices of trivia or anything philatelic in nature, please let us know. We want to know what you would like to have in the newsletter if it it is not there already.

Dealers - A suggestion was made that maybe you would like to put coupons in the Philatex. This would be good advertizing for your businesses, and also benefit all SAPA members.

We hope to make this an interesting and fun newsletter for our club. Thanks for the opportunity to serve you.

Dora Roberts & Lea Senghaas

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us:
Lea - lys@satx.rr.com
Dora - dora.roberts@hotmail.com
Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Jane K Fohn
Vice President:	Richard Rose
Secretary:	Bro. Ed Loch
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Volunteer Needed
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Pearson
Librarian:	

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Jane K Fohn
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Bob Joyce
One year term:	Patrick J Ryan
Two year term:	Pat Richmond
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member:	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)
Publicity (Chairman):	Volunteer Needed

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Philatelic Society:	Jane K Fohn
Texas Philatelic Society:	Robert J. Joyce
U.S. Postal Service:	Steve E. Canedo
APS Circuit Books:	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Circuit Books:	Jane K Fohn

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE:

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

SAPA AUCTION RULES

REGULAR AUCTION:

Everyone is allowed to buy at our auctions, but only members may sell items.

Each seller may submit 15 lots per auction. Sellers must be present at the auction (unless special permission is granted by the Board of Governors).

All lots must have Auction slips attached. Accurate information must be stated on the slips, with defects noted. Value of the lot should be $1.00 or greater.

Buyers may return lots that were incorrectly identified, or which have defects not noted on the slip. Buyers should examine their lots before the next auction to inform auctioneer of any problems. Buyers are expected to abide by the auctioneer's decision on returned lots. However, dissatisfied buyers may appeal to the Board of Governors if they disagree with the auctioneer. The Board's decision will be final.

The auctioneer will accept lots up to 20 minutes prior to the start of the auction. He has the right to close lot acceptance after 135 lots have been entered. Lots with incorrect information can be refused. The current Scott catalog is the primary guide to stamp identification and value; when necessary, other catalogs may be used.

Minimum starting bid on lots is 50¢ (unless a higher starting bid is stated), and $1.00 for donation lots. Bidding is in increments of 25¢ up to $5.00, increases to 50¢ increments up to $15.00, increases to $1.00 increments up to $50.00, and thereafter to $5.00 increments.

Buyers pay current sales tax on all lots purchased, unless the buyer has a state resale permit. The club receives a 10 % commission from the seller on all sold lots. All unsold lots will be returned to the seller when the auction is concluded. There is no charge for unsold lots.

Items that are donated to the club for auction may be combined with other items to increase saleability of the lot.

BLUE CHIP AUCTION:

Rules are the same as for regular auctions except that the material submitted must catalog a minimum of $5.00. Minimum starting bid will apply unless a higher starting bid is stated. All material is to be of Fine or better quality with no defects. Individual mint stamps should have 'original gum hinged' or better (unless stamp was issued with no gum). Quality individual items, complete sets, and rare treasures are encouraged. Auctioneers' decisions on lot acceptability are final.

Sellers must prepare blue chip lots well in advance. Lots need to be turned in to the auctioneer at a date to be announced. This is so publication of the lots can be written up in the Philatex, and mail-in bids can then be accepted in addition to bids on the floor. Since the Philatex is bimonthly, the time frame could be 10-12 weeks prior to the auction.

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PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Jane Fohn

What a great start for 2008! We have had a good attendance, and everyone had a good time.

Pat Richmond has scheduled a year of interesting programs. You will find "Program Notes" for upcoming speakers in this *Philatex*. Even if you do not collect the specialty, there will be something to learn that may apply to your collection.

We are actively publicizing SAPA. Did you hear our mention on Texas Public Radio! A number of our members did, and there was response. It aired one time on January 31st.

SAPA needs some volunteers. Jeff White is unable to continue with the publicity and communications. This is not too time consuming, but someone is definitely needed to handle it. The position requires periodic contact with local newspapers and broadcast media. You may get in touch with me if you would like to volunteer.

Other volunteers are needed to pick up water board envelopes. The stamps are clipped from these covers then set out at meetings for members to go through and purchase them for 3-cents each. The water board stamps are a great way to keep up with new issues for your United States collection! These stamps are also sold to a Canadian who processes them, and then resells them in Canada. These sales add significant proceeds to SAPA's treasury. Contact Jack Virta if you would like to help.

Don't forget the 2007 *Scott Catalogues* are always available for check out, and the 2008s are for use at our meetings. Just ask me for them

American Philatelic Society and Oklahoma Philatelic Society stamp circuits are at meetings for your perusal. The only meeting that they are not available is the auction night. See Pat Ryan and Jane Fohn for these.

Why don't you come join us to see what your stamp club has to offer?

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MEMBERS HIP MEMOS :

Greetings from your membership chairperson. Welcome to another new year. I hope this will be a new and exciting time for us. Thank you for paying your dues. If you have a current email address that is not on the Philatex, and you would like it to be, please let me know. If your address has changed, phone number, etc., please let me know as well, so I can keep everything current and efficient for you.

I am presently adding new things to the new membership packets. If you are a dealer and have flyers that would be of interest to new members, I would appreciate them. If you also have ideas on what might be good to include, all ideas will be received with thanks.

Thank you for your support in the years past. I look forward to serving you in the future.

Sincerely, Dora Roberts
SAPA Membership Chairperson

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The Following Members have been regretfully dropped:

Denise Johnson David Squire Wesley Waldman
Raymond Joles Donald Swartz **Juniors:**
Mike Kramer Ralph Swederske Maya Coltrane
Dolores Lopez Dianne Taylor Blake Riley
Gail Robertson Tamiko Thompson Michael Thompson
Craig Robison Johnny Wimpy

We will happily reinstate them upon request.

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Program Notes

March 7, 2008 - "Show and Tell"
Dub Weatherford's Statue of Liberty Project presented by Richard Spies

Richard will be showing 2 bound albums that were created by Dub Weatherford. Their central theme is the Statue of Liberty.

The first album is one Dub made from a souvenier booklet. Dub bought a souvenier book titled, Keeper of Dreams by Margo Nash published in 1983 by Manhattan Post Card Publishing Co. from the Statue of Liberty Gift Center. He created a truly unique philatelic and neumismatic item of interest. He attached coins in appropriate places in the album. Philatelic items were mounted and displayed to correspond with the theme of each chapter and article.

The second album contains miscellaneous Commemorative Philatelic and Numismatic Items of interest. We are looking forward to seeing Dub's handywork, Richard.

April 18, 2008

"Pictorial Cancellationsby Charles Shelby

Charles will show several cancellations with pictures. These cancellations are usually issued at shows or to celebrate some special occasion. He will include copies of the cancellations. This should be a "picturesque" evening.

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UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

MAR 8-9 TSDA STAMP FAIR - Bourse at the Norris Conference Center, at the north end of Crossroads Mall on the lower level, from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. on Saturdays; and 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. on Sundays. (Note: this is a change of venue due to construction)

MAR 14-15 TEXAS PRECANCEL CLUB SPRING ROUNDUP - Spring auction & bourse of the Texas Precancel Club at the Clarion Inn, 1503 S. Texas Ave., College Station, Texas. Hours: Friday 9 a.m. to ? p.m., Saturday 8 a.m. to 5 p.m., Auction on Saturday at 2 p.m. Contact: Katherine Foster, khfoster@tex.net.

ARCHIVOLOGY

Where we dig interesting articles out of the past.

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AIRSHIP COLUMBIA VISITS HEMISFAIR '68
by Jim Beer
from The Philatex June 1970

Every collector has his hang-up. Mine is airship mail. During Hemisfair '68, the Goodyear Blimp Columbia came to San Antonio to be here during the fair. Without fanfare, the arrival of the Columbia was announced on the Sunday evening news on June 2, 1968. Immediately my phone began ringing and two other collectors and I decided we should get some covers canceled on the historic date! Cards and covers were franked and rushed to the main post-office to get them posted June 2, 1968. This was done and the first part was completed. Now to get them flown!

One of our people had a contact with the Goodyear people and made arrangments to have our covers actually flown on the blimp. All the covers were gathered together and placed in an old auction catalogue envelope with bulk rate franking. The great day arrived and the cards and covers were sent to the airport for the flight. Each piece was autographed by one of the airship pilots. On September 30, 1968 the mail was flown over San Antonio on one of the flights of Airship N 2 A Blimp colombia. the package of covers in the auction catalogue with a Bulk Rate frank was duly certified as flown by the blimp pilot, sealed with scotch tape, and instead of being returned by our contact, DROPPED IN THE MAILBOX! The next day the postman delivered the flown pieces to my office in the old Auction Catalogue envelope with the old Bulk Rate frank without a word about postage due!

And so ends another page in the history of Airship Mail. Atotal of 38 cards and covers were carried on this historic flight, making these items in the class of rare airship mail. The World's Fair ended October 6, 1968 and the Columbia departed that date never to return. The Blimp Columbia has since been retired, but the memory of its visit to the Hemisfair '68 lives on in the form of some rare flown covers.

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